

Phishing Email Analysis and IOC Extraction Report

Project: Phishing Email Analysis and IOC Extraction Workflow

Case Study: Your Recent Purchase

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Classification: Phishing Email

1. Executive Summary

This report analyzes a phishing email that impersonates Apple Support by sending a fake purchase notification. The attacker attempts to create panic by claiming an unauthorized App Store purchase and urges the recipient to take immediate action. The campaign relies on sender spoofing, BCC distribution, social engineering, and a malicious attachment to compromise users.

2. Scenario Overview

The phishing email claims that the recipient recently purchased an App Store item and must take immediate action if the purchase is unauthorized. The email appears to originate from Apple Support but actually comes from a suspicious domain. A malicious Microsoft Word template (.dot) attachment is included to encourage the recipient to open it, potentially executing malicious content.

3. Phishing Techniques Identified

Spoofed Sender Identity

- The display name is Apple Support.
- The actual sender domain is unrelated to Apple.
- The sender attempts to gain the recipient's trust through brand impersonation.

Blind Carbon Copy (BCC)

- The recipient was included through the BCC field.
- This hides the full recipient list and enables mass phishing campaigns.

Artificial Urgency

- The subject line contains "Action Required".
- The email creates panic by reporting an unauthorized purchase.

Poor Grammar and Typographical Errors

- Several spelling and formatting mistakes appear within the email.
- These inconsistencies are common indicators of phishing.

Malicious Attachment

- The email contains a Microsoft Word Template (.dot) attachment.
- This unusual attachment format may contain malicious macros or embedded malware.



4. Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

IOC Type	Value
Display Name	Apple Support
Brand Used	Apple
Sender Domain	Suspicious / non-Apple Domain
Attachment Type	Microsoft Word Template (.dot)
Attack Category	Phishing
Delivery Method	Email Attachment
Distribution Method	Blind Carbon Copy (BCC)



The diagram illustrates the flow of the phishing attack. It starts with an attachment icon labeled "Double Jack... .dot". An arrow points down to a box labeled "Attachment". Another arrow points down to a box labeled "Redirect Link". Below the "Redirect Link" box is a long URL: <https://tumblr.com/redirect?z=https://apps.ios-games.mansiiea.com/?njhdhw10d&t=zmm3mgu4nmfmjvknzbjodg1mde2nzfhnm0nzdtkodnmzmzhlzmzzjosxhmdrlmtc5y2njinmndcwyzdyzdyzjnzjzmmjmotc2mtk2mzlm>. Below the URL is the instruction "Ctrl + Click to follow link".

Save 3% on all your Apple purchases with Apple Card. Apply and use in minutes.

APPLE ID: example@appleid.com DATE: Apr 03, 2020 ORDER ID: MN HLSF 45X G

DOCUMENT NO.: 137320441420 BILLED TO: [123 Pine St., Springfield, IL 62704, USA]

App Store

Product Icon	Product Details	Price
	Title: Double Jackpot Slots Las Vegas, Large pack of coins Type: In-App Purchase Device: iPhone	\$14.99

[Report a Problem](#)

Large Image

5. Analysis Findings

Subject Analysis

The subject line uses "Action Required" to create urgency and pressure the recipient into responding quickly.

Sender Analysis

Although the display name is Apple Support, the underlying sender domain is unrelated to Apple, indicating sender spoofing.

Recipient Analysis

The recipient was included through the BCC field, suggesting that the email was distributed as part of a mass phishing campaign.

Content Analysis

The email claims that the user made an unauthorized App Store purchase and encourages immediate action. Fear and urgency are used to manipulate the recipient.

Attachment Analysis

The attached .dot file is unusual for a purchase receipt. Opening it may result in:

- Malicious macro execution
- Malware installation
- Additional payload downloads
- System compromise

6. Detection Opportunities

- Detect suspicious attachment types.
- Scan attachments in a sandbox.
- Alert on brand impersonation.

7. Risk Assessment

Risk Level: High

Severity: High

Confidence: High

Category: Phishing / Malware Delivery

Reasons

- Apple brand impersonation
- Sender domain mismatch
- BCC distribution
- Malicious Word template attachment
- Urgency-based social engineering
- Potential malware execution

8. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique ID : T1566.001

Technique Name : Phishing: Spearphishing Attachment

The attacker delivers a malicious attachment through email to persuade the victim to open the file, potentially leading to malware execution or credential compromise.

9. Recommended Actions

1. Do not open the attachment.
2. Verify purchase notifications through the official Apple account.
3. Block the sender's email address and domain.
4. Report the email to the security team.
5. Scan the attachment in a sandbox before analysis.
6. Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) on Apple accounts.
7. Educate users about fake purchase notification scams.

10. Conclusion

This email is a phishing attempt that impersonates Apple Support to trick recipients into opening a malicious attachment. Multiple indicators—including sender spoofing, BCC distribution, urgency-based social engineering, and the use of an unusual Microsoft Word template attachment—confirm that the email should be classified as malicious and blocked.